



▲ **In June 2015**, Indians travelled in a special train to Lahore to attend the death anniversary of Maharaja Ranjit Singh (1801–39), ruler of the Sikh Empire of Punjab. They are seen here at the Wagah station.

Train of accord

After Independence, hostilities between India and Pakistan put paid to any hopes of easy train travel between the two countries until the end of the 1971 Indo-Pakistan war and the creation of Bangladesh, formerly East Pakistan. According to one of the outcomes of the 1972 Simla Agreement, a peace treaty between India and Pakistan, the Governments would promote travel facilities for the citizens of both countries in an effort to “restore and normalize relations”. This was furthered by the Samjhauta Express, which means accord or compromise in Hindi and Urdu, which started services on 22 July 1976, running between Amritsar and Lahore. In the late 1980s, increased security concerns saw the train from India terminating at Attari, a town 3 km from the India–Pakistan border at Wagah in Punjab. Here,